THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH FULL SYLLABUS PAPER SET 04

Reading · Writing & Grammar · Literature (First Flight, Poetry, Footprints Without Feet) | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours 15 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A (Reading, 20 marks): Q. 1–2, passages with 10 sub-questions each (1 mark each).
3. Section B (Writing, 12 marks): Q. 3 Notice (3), Q. 4 Letter (5), Q. 5 Analytical paragraph (4).
4. Section C (Grammar, 8 marks): Q. 6–13 (1 mark each).
5. Section D–G (Literature, 40 marks): Q. 14–21 objective (1 mark each), Q. 22–24 extract-based (4 marks each), Q. 25–28 short answer (2 marks each), Q. 29–32 long answer (3 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 3, 4, 5 and Q. 29 to 32.
7. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading: 20 Marks) — 20 Marks

Read the passages and answer the questions that follow.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

When a little child learns to walk, nobody scolds her for falling. We clap when she stands, laugh when she sits down hard and lift her again. Somewhere between the age of three and the age of thirteen, we change the rules. A fall becomes a disgrace, and the child learns that the safest way never to fail is never to try anything new.

This is a pity, because almost every important discovery has a pile of failures behind it. A scientist who tries a hundred experiments and finds ninety-nine of them wrong has not wasted ninety-nine days; she has found ninety-nine ways that do not work, and is now much closer to the one that does. A cricketer who is out for a duck in the first over learns something about the pitch that a hundred runs would never have taught him.

The fear of failure is also catching. Pupils who are frightened of making mistakes stop asking questions, and a class that does not ask questions slowly stops thinking. Teachers sometimes make this worse by praising only the highest marks. A better habit is to ask the child, after every test, 'What did you learn from the questions you got wrong?'

None of this means that failure is pleasant. It hurts, and it is right that it should. But the hurt is useful, like the pain that tells us to take our hand away from a flame. A person who has failed and tried again has something that no examination can award: the knowledge that she can get up.

(i) Why does the writer begin with the example of a child learning to walk? 1

(a) To describe a game **(b)** To show that we accept falling then but not later

(c) To criticise children **(d)** To praise parents

(ii) As children grow older, a fall becomes: 1

(a) a duty **(b)** a reward **(c)** a disgrace **(d)** a game

(iii) According to the writer, the scientist with ninety-nine failed experiments has: 1

(a) wasted her time **(b)** found ninety-nine ways that do not work

(c) given up **(d)** proved herself wrong

(iv) Pupils who fear mistakes: 1

(a) stop asking questions **(b)** teach others

(c) ask more questions **(d)** score higher

(v) The hurt of failure is compared to: 1

(a) pain that makes us pull our hand from a flame **(b)** a gift

(c) a loud noise **(d)** a holiday

(vi) What question does the writer suggest teachers should ask after a test? 1

(vii) What does a cricketer learn from being out for a duck? 1

(viii) What does a person who has failed and tried again gain? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'something to be ashamed of'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'spreading from one person to another'. 1

2. *Read the following poster and answer the questions that follow.* 10

> The school notice board carried the following poster.
>
> **ST. MARY'S PUBLIC SCHOOL — 'TRY AGAIN' WEEK**
>
> Venue: Auditorium | Date: 14–18 November 2026 | Time: 11:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.
>
> Day 1: Talk by an Olympic athlete | Day 2: Science of mistakes (workshop) | Day 3: 'My biggest failure' – student stories
>
> Day 4: Fun quiz – wrong answers also win marks! | Day 5: Certificates and refreshments
>
> Entry free for students of Classes 8–12. Register with your class teacher by 10 November.

(i) What is the venue of the programme? 1

(a) Playground **(b)** Library **(c)** Classroom **(d)** Auditorium

(ii) On which day will students tell their own stories? 1

(a) Day 3 **(b)** Day 4 **(c)** Day 5 **(d)** Day 1

(iii) Who can attend the programme? 1

(a) Students of Classes 8–12 **(b)** Teachers only

(c) Parents only **(d)** Only Class 10

(iv) What is the last date for registration? 1

(v) For how many hours does the programme run each day? 1

(vi) Who will speak on the first day? 1

(vii) What is special about the quiz on Day 4? 1

(viii) Why do you think the school chose this theme? 1

(ix) Is there any fee for attending? 1

(x) Find a word in the poster which means 'a place where an event is held'. 1

SECTION — B (Writing Skills: 12 Marks) — 12 Marks

Internal choice is given in each question.

3. Your school wants to start a Yoga class for students. Write a notice in not more than 50 words. You are the Physical Education Teacher. 3

OR

You have found a wristwatch in the school corridor. Write a notice in not more than 50 words. You are Yash/Yamini of Class 10. 3

4. You are Raman/Ramya of 21, Shiv Colony, Udaipur. Write a letter to the Manager of a bookshop, in about 120 words, placing an order for some books. 5

OR

You are Lata/Lalit. Write a letter to your friend, in about 120 words, inviting him/her to spend the summer vacation with you. 5

5. Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'The Benefits of Learning a Second Language'. 4

OR

Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'The Use of Mobile Phones in Schools'. 4

SECTION — C (Grammar: 8 Marks) — 8 Marks

Attempt all the questions.

6. Fill in the blank with the correct form: She _____ (sing) since morning. 1

7. Choose the correct modal: The doctor said that I _____ rest for a week. (should / can / might) 1

8. Fill in the blank with the right article: He is _____ best player of the team. 1

9. Rewrite in reported speech: The teacher said, "The earth moves round the sun." 1

10. Change into passive voice: He will write a letter. 1

11. Join using 'when': I reached home. It started raining. 1

12. Find and correct the error: He is senior than me. 1

13. Rearrange to form a meaningful sentence: the / sun / sets / west / in / the 1

SECTION — D (Literature: Objective Type) — 8 Marks

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

14. The tone of the author in 'A Baker from Goa' is mainly: 1

(a) fearful **(b)** angry **(c)** nostalgic **(d)** bitter

15. Maxwell went to the Basra Consulate-General to: 1

(a) buy an otter **(b)** collect and answer his mail
(c) book a flight **(d)** meet the consul

16. The town was how far from her village? 1

(a) Ten miles **(b)** Sixteen miles **(c)** Three miles **(d)** Six miles

17. The poet does not offer the boy money because: 1

(a) no money can replace the learning from loss
(b) he has none
(c) he is shy
(d) the boy refuses

18. The voices in stanzas 1, 3, 5 and 7 are those of: 1

(a) a teacher only **(b)** Amanda
(c) a friend **(d)** a nagging adult/elder

19. Griffin became a homeless wanderer because he: 1

(a) was thrown out by the police
(b) lost his job
(c) ran away from home
(d) had to remove his clothes to escape unseen

20. Ebright collected butterflies because he: 1

(a) was told to do so
(b) was an only child with no team to play with
(c) wanted to be a zoologist
(d) wanted to sell them

21. Mme Loisel did not like visiting her rich friend because: 1

(a) she lived far away **(b)** she suffered so much when she returned
(c) the friend was rude **(d)** she was jealous of her husband

SECTION — E (Literature: Extract-based Questions) — 12 Marks

Read the extracts and answer the questions that follow.

22. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> Valli was a curious eight-year-old who enjoyed standing at her front door and watching the street. There were no children of her age nearby, but she did not mind. She found the street as interesting as any game. The hourly bus, with fresh passengers each time, was the greatest joy of all, and gradually she began to wish she could ride in it just once.

(i) What was Valli's favourite pastime? 1

(ii) Why did she spend time alone? 1

(iii) What grew in her head? 1

(iv) Find a word in the passage that means 'of great interest'. 1

23. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> Sandburg describes the fog as coming on little cat feet. It arrives quietly, without announcing itself, just as a cat approaches. The image makes the fog seem soft, gentle and alive.

(i) How does the fog come? 1

(ii) What is the fog compared to? 1

(iii) What quality does this suggest? 1

(iv) Is it a simile or a metaphor? 1

24. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> In the seventh grade, Ebright entered a county science fair with slides of frog tissues and lost. He felt sad, but realised the winners had done real experiments instead of making a neat display. He decided to do real experiments the next year. He wrote to Dr Urquhart for ideas, and these kept him busy throughout high school.

(i) What did Ebright display at the fair? 1

(ii) Why did he lose? 1

(iii) What did he decide? 1

(iv) Whom did he write to for ideas? 1

SECTION — F (Literature: Short Answer Type) — 8 Marks

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

25. What was the first quarrel about and how did it end? 2

26. Why were two national anthems sung at the ceremony? 2

27. What does Anne say she can do to change things? 2

28. Why did Ramlal send Bholi to school? 2

SECTION — G (Literature: Long Answer Type) — 12 Marks

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

29. Why is Coorg called 'coffee country'? Describe its geography and climate. 3

OR

'There are two kinds of conflict in the story.' Explain. 3

30. Describe the character of M. Loisel. 3

OR

Why did Anil not hand over the thief to the police? 3

31. Who do you think helped the narrator reach safely? Give reasons. 3

OR

Describe the character of Max. 3

32. What does the poem say about growing up? 3

OR

List some poetic devices used in the poem with examples. 3

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 80 Marks